

# Bylaws

Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order

## Bylaws

***Article I — Name, Nature, and Interpretation The name of this corporation shall be Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order The Order is a nonprofit, nonstock corporation organized exclusively for lawful nonprofit purposes as set forth in its Articles of Incorporation.***

The Order may use historical or ceremonial titles inspired by the medieval Knights Templar, including but not limited to Grand Master, Seneschal, Marshal, Preceptor, Prior, Treasurer, Draper, Knight, Sergeant, Chaplain, Squire, and Novice. All titles, ranks, honors, vestments, regalia, insignia, and ceremonial offices are purely internal and nonprofit in character. No office, title, or rank shall be construed as conferring civil, military, police, security, ecclesiastical, governmental, or sovereign authority outside the internal governance of the Order.

***Article II — Mission and Purposes The mission of the Order is to cultivate fraternity, honor, service, charity, spiritual formation, historical study, and disciplined ethical conduct through a chivalric-inspired nonprofit order.***

The Order is organized to: promote charitable, educational, religious, historical, literary, scientific, and fraternal activities; study and preserve the history, symbolism, and heritage associated with the Knights Templar and related traditions; conduct lawful ceremonies, convocations, retreats, lectures, publications, and service projects; promote fellowship and moral formation among members; establish and supervise subordinate commanderies, preceptories, chapters, priories, lodges, or houses if authorized; and conduct any lawful activities consistent with the Articles and applicable tax-exempt status.

The Order shall not function as a militia, paramilitary body, private army, law-enforcement organization, or private security force; conduct patrol, enforcement, or crowd-control operations; claim official continuity with the medieval Knights Templar, any sovereign order, any church, or any governmental body unless lawfully established and expressly documented; or permit private inurement, unlawful private benefit, or unlawful distributions.

***Article III — Membership The Order may recognize the following classes of membership: Novice or Postulant; Squire; Sergeant Member; Knight Member; Chaplain Member; Honorary Member; and such additional classes as may be created by amendment.***

Membership classes are internal distinctions for formation, service, ceremonial role, and governance eligibility. They do not create transferable ownership rights in the corporation.

Eligibility shall be determined by written admissions standards approved by the Board and Grand Chapter. Such standards may include minimum age, character, agreement with mission, and spiritual, ethical, or service commitments. Applicants may be admitted through sponsorship, petition, interview, training, probationary period, and formal reception.

A member remains in good standing by complying with the governing documents, maintaining conduct consistent with mission and code of conduct, paying dues or receiving an approved waiver, and avoiding

acts materially injurious to the Order.

***Article IV — Advancement, Formation, and Discipline The Order may establish a formation path through one or more stages, such as Novice, Squire, Sergeant, and Knight, together with separate qualifications for Chaplains and Grand Officers.***

Advancement may be based on instruction, conduct, service, attendance, mentorship, examination, retreat participation, oath or promise, or other lawful criteria adopted by the Order.

The Board shall adopt a written code of conduct addressing integrity, lawful conduct, fiduciary honesty, anti-harassment standards, nonviolence, truthful public representation, confidentiality where appropriate, respect for members, and protection of Order property and reputation.

A member may be admonished, suspended, removed from office, reduced in rank, or expelled for fraud or financial misconduct, violence or threats, harassment or unlawful discrimination, false claims of authority or lineage, serious bylaw violations, or conduct materially injurious to the Order. Except in emergencies involving immediate risk, discipline shall require written notice, an opportunity to respond, review by the designated body, a written decision, and an appeal process.

***Article V — Corporate Membership Structure The corporation shall operate as a [member / nonmember] nonprofit corporation under the law of the State of [State]. If it is a member corporation, voting rights shall be as described in these bylaws.***

Unless otherwise required by state law, only members designated as voting members in these bylaws shall vote on corporate matters. The Order may limit voting rights to Knights in good standing, Chaplains in good standing, elected officers, charter representatives from subordinate bodies, or another class established by amendment.

If subordinate bodies exist, each chartered body in good standing may send delegates or representatives to the Grand Chapter in the number established by ordinance or policy.

***Article VI — The Grand Chapter and Board of Directors The supreme fraternal body of the Order shall be the Grand Chapter, also called the Grand Convent, Supreme Council, or such other name as the Order may adopt. The Grand Chapter shall exercise the highest internal ceremonial and legislative authority of the Order, subject to the Articles, these bylaws, and applicable law.***

The corporate affairs of the Order shall be managed under the direction of the Board of Directors. The Board retains ultimate fiduciary responsibility under civil law for finances, compliance, and governance.

The Board shall consist of not fewer than the minimum number required by state law and initially shall consist of [3 / 5 / 7] directors. Directors must be adults and meet any additional qualifications established by the Order. The Order may require directors to be members in good standing.

Directors shall be elected by the voting body designated in these bylaws for terms of [one / two / three] years and until their successors are elected and qualified. Directors may be removed in the manner required by state law and these bylaws. Vacancies may be filled by the Board unless state law requires another method.

***Article VII — Officers of the Order The principal officers of the Order shall be Grand Master, Seneschal, Chancellor or Secretary, Treasurer, and such other officers as the bylaws provide. The Order may also have a Marshal, Prior or Chaplain General, Draper, Preceptor or Commander General, Turcopolier or Auxiliary Coordinator,***

### ***Almoner, and additional officers established by the Grand Chapter.***

For purposes of civil law, unless otherwise expressly provided: Grand Master serves as President or Chair; Seneschal serves as Vice President; Chancellor serves as Secretary; and Treasurer serves as Treasurer.

The Grand Master presides at meetings, provides mission leadership, supervises officers subject to Board authority, and represents the Order publicly. The Seneschal assists and acts in the Grand Master's absence. The Chancellor or Secretary maintains minutes, notices, rolls, charters, records, and correspondence. The Treasurer supervises receipts, accounts, budgets, disbursements, reports, and financial controls. The Marshal supervises ceremonial order, processions, convocations, and event logistics only, and has no police, military, or security authority. The Prior or Chaplain General oversees spiritual observances and pastoral support. The Draper supervises approved regalia, habits, mantles, banners, insignia, and ceremonial presentation. The Preceptor or Commander General coordinates subordinate bodies, training, formation, or chapter support as assigned.

***Article VIII — Subordinate Bodies The Order may charter subordinate commanderies, preceptories, priories, lodges, houses, or chapters by written instrument. Each subordinate body shall be created by formal charter; operate under the Articles, bylaws, rituals, rules, and lawful directives of the parent Order; maintain officers, rolls, minutes, and financial records; submit periodic activity and financial reports; and remain largely self-governing in local matters, subject to the authority of the parent Order.***

A charter may be suspended or revoked for cause, including inactivity, financial misconduct, insubordination, unlawful conduct, or failure to report.

***Article IX — Meetings The Order shall hold an annual convocation or annual meeting at a time and place determined by the Board or Grand Master. The Board, Grand Chapter, and subordinate bodies may hold regular meetings as established by schedule or policy. Special meetings may be called by the Grand Master, the Chair of the Board, a specified number of directors, or such other persons as these bylaws provide.***

Notice of meetings shall be given in the manner and within the time required by state law or these bylaws. Quorum rules for the Board, Grand Chapter, and subordinate bodies shall be established by policy or bylaw, provided that no quorum rule violates state law. Meetings may be held by lawful remote means if permitted by state law and authorized by the Board.

***Article X — Voting Each voting member, director, delegate, or officer entitled to vote shall have one vote unless these bylaws expressly provide otherwise. Proxy voting shall be [permitted / prohibited] except as required or allowed by state law. Except where a greater vote is required by law, the Articles, or these bylaws, action shall be approved by a majority of votes cast at a meeting where a quorum is present.***

***Article XI — Finances, Dues, and Property The fiscal year of the Order shall be fixed by resolution of the Board. The Order may impose initiation fees, annual dues, assessments, or contributions, subject to policies adopted by the governing body. All funds, property, and assets shall be used solely to further nonprofit purposes. Funds shall be deposited in accounts approved by the Board. Disbursements shall be made only by persons authorized by the Board, which may require dual signatures, approval***

*thresholds, or other controls. No loans shall be made by the Order to its directors or officers except as lawful and expressly approved. Accurate books, records, minutes, rosters, charters, financial statements, and reports shall be maintained, and the Board may require internal review or external audit.*

***Article XII — Conflict of Interest and Compensation** The Order shall maintain a conflict-of-interest policy requiring disclosure of actual or potential conflicts by directors, officers, and key persons. A conflicted person shall not improperly participate in deliberation or voting on a matter in which that person has a disqualifying financial interest. No part of the net earnings of the Order shall inure to the benefit of private persons. Reasonable compensation may be paid for services actually rendered if approved in accordance with law and policy.*

***Article XIII — Seal, Insignia, and Regalia** The Order may adopt a corporate seal by resolution. The Order may adopt insignia, crosses, mantles, badges, banners, and other emblems, provided they do not unlawfully infringe existing intellectual property rights and do not falsely imply governmental or ecclesiastical authority. The Board may regulate the manufacture, display, sale, and authorized use of insignia and regalia.*

***Article XIV — Policies and Compliance** The Board shall adopt such policies as are reasonably necessary for lawful and prudent governance, including financial controls, document retention, code of conduct, and, where relevant, youth protection or anti-harassment policies. The Order shall comply with applicable charitable solicitation laws before soliciting contributions in any jurisdiction. Required federal and state tax filings shall be made in a timely manner. No officer or member may make public claims of official succession, sovereign status, military authority, law-enforcement function, or tax status without Board authorization and factual basis.*

***Article XV — Indemnification and Parliamentary Authority** To the fullest extent permitted by state law, the Order shall indemnify its directors, officers, and agents against liabilities and expenses incurred in connection with their service to the Order, provided they acted in good faith and in a manner reasonably believed to be in the best interests of the Order.*

Meetings of the Order may be governed by the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised, except where inconsistent with law, the Articles, or these bylaws.

***Article XVI — Amendments** These bylaws may be amended by the vote of [two-thirds] of the voting body entitled to amend them, provided written notice of the proposed amendment is given in advance. No amendment shall be valid if inconsistent with the Articles of Incorporation, applicable nonprofit law, or the federal tax status of the Order.*